DWELLY

Enhanced Training Strategy 2025 – 2026

A next-generation approach to building lasting knowledge across Dwelly — designed to beat the forgetting curve, drive genuine competency, and embed a culture of continuous learning.

5	12	80%+	30+
Learning Strategies	Months	Retention Target	Team Members

The problem we are solving

Research by Hermann Ebbinghaus shows that without reinforcement, people forget up to 70% of new information within 24 hours and up to 90% within a week. Standard one-time training — reading a PDF, watching a video once — does not create lasting knowledge. The enhanced Dwelly programme is built specifically to counter this.

THE FORGETTING CURVE — AND HOW WE FIGHT IT

TIMEFRAME	RETENTION WITHOUT REINFORCEMENT	DWELLY COUNTERMEASURE
Day 1	~58% retained	**Same-day micro quiz (3 questions)**
Day 3	~35% retained	**Spaced repetition prompt via Dobby**
Week 1	~20% retained	**Module knowledge check + scenario**
Month 1	~10% retained	**Role-play scenario or case study review**
Quarter	Near zero without use	**Quarterly refresher + live application log**

THE 5 STRATEGIES BUILT INTO THIS PROGRAMME

01 **Spaced Repetition**
Content is revisited at increasing intervals — day 1, day 3, week 1, month 1. Each revisit deepens retention without overloading staff.

02 **Active Recall**
Instead of passive re-reading, staff are tested on what they remember. Quizzes, scenario prompts, and Dobby challenges replace re-watching videos.

03 **Interleaving**
Modules mix topics rather than covering one thing exhaustively. A session might combine a maintenance process, a compliance rule, and a system task — mirroring real work.

04 **Contextual Application**
Training is tied to real tasks. After completing a module, staff apply it on a live case and log it. Learning happens in context, not in isolation.

05 **Retrieval Practice**
The portal prompts staff to recall information before showing it to them. "What are the steps to log a repair?" before the answer is revealed.

What the finance sector does — and how Dwelly can adopt it

Financial services firms operate under strict FCA regulation and have spent decades perfecting competency-based training. The ideas below are drawn directly from that world — firms like St. James's Place, Quilter, and Curtis Banks — and adapted for property management.

Competency Passport

FINANCE MODEL

Financial advisers carry a personal competency record that follows them throughout their career. Every training module completed, every assessment passed, and every CPD hour logged is recorded permanently.

DWELLY APPLICATION

Each property manager has a Competency Passport in the portal. Completions are date-stamped and exportable. This becomes a reference point at appraisals, during audits, and when considering promotion.

Structured CPD Logging

FINANCE MODEL

Regulated firms require structured CPD (Continuing Professional Development) hours per year, split between formal learning, technical updates, and reflective practice.

DWELLY APPLICATION

Log CPD hours against portal completions and external courses (e.g. ARLA Propertymark, Rightmove Plus). Target: 20 hours per year per PM. Dashboard shows progress toward the annual target.

Competency Sign-Off Gates

FINANCE MODEL

Before an adviser can handle certain products or advise on complex cases, a supervisor must formally sign off their competency. There is no self-certification.

DWELLY APPLICATION

High-risk areas — deposit disputes, section 21 notices, gas safety non-compliance — require a manager sign-off before a PM can handle them solo. The portal tracks who is signed off for what.

T&C; Supervision Framework

FINANCE MODEL

Training & Competency (T&C;) frameworks in finance define how long new staff are supervised, what evidence is needed to "go solo", and how performance issues trigger re-training.

DWELLY APPLICATION

New PMs have a 90-day supervised period. At each milestone, the manager confirms observation evidence in the portal. Completion unlocks the next level of independence and responsibility.

Annual Re-Certification

FINANCE MODEL

Even experienced staff re-certify on key knowledge areas each year — not because they are untrusted, but because rules change and reinforcement is proven to matter.

DWELLY APPLICATION

Every December, all PMs complete a short re-certification on compliance-critical topics: deposit protection, gas safety, and tenancy legislation. Automated via the portal with a pass/fail record.

What to build into the portal — beyond the basics

01 Learning Pathways by Role

Not all staff need the same training. Build role-specific pathways — Property Manager, Maintenance Coordinator, Lettings Negotiator — so each person sees only what is relevant. Finance sector equivalent: adviser pathways vs. support staff pathways.

02 Spaced Repetition Engine

After a module is completed, the portal automatically schedules a follow-up micro-test at day 3, day 7, and day 30. Staff receive a portal notification: "Quick recall check on Deposit Protection — 3 questions, 2 minutes." This is the single biggest driver of long-term retention.

03 Scenario-Based Assessments

Move beyond multiple choice. Present a real-world scenario: "A tenant reports a boiler fault on a Friday evening. The landlord is unresponsive. What do you do and in what order?" Answers are assessed against the SOP — not just fact recall but applied judgement.

04 Dobby Challenge Mode

Once per week, Dobby sends each PM a challenge question drawn from their recently completed modules. A short, low-stakes prompt that forces retrieval. Results are not graded — they are used by the system to flag if a refresher is needed.

05 Peer Learning Boards

A section of the portal where PMs can submit anonymised "situations" they encountered — what happened, what they did, and what they learned. Other staff can read and comment. Modelled on the case study approach used in financial adviser CPD.

06 Pre-Task Primers

Before a PM handles a specific task type for the first time (e.g. serving a Section 21 notice), the portal auto-sends a short primer: the key steps, the most common mistakes, and a link to the relevant video. Triggered by task type in the property management system.

07 Video Transcript Search

Every training video has a searchable transcript. Staff can type "deposit deduction evidence" and jump directly to the relevant 45-second clip. Reduces the need to watch an entire video when looking for a specific answer.

08 Confidence Rating per Module

After each module, ask staff to rate their confidence: 1 (not confident) to 5 (very confident). Low confidence flags trigger an automatic manager notification and a Dobby follow-up. Self-reported gaps are often the most accurate.

Training content ideas beyond the standard modules

CONTENT FORMATS TO BUILD IN

FORMAT	DESCRIPTION	RETENTION IMPACT	EFFORT TO BUILD
Micro-learning clips (90 sec)	Single-topic video covering one concept only. Easier to watch, revisit, and recall than long modules	HIGH	LOW (Claude scripts in minutes)
Decision trees	Visual flowcharts for complex decisions — e.g. "Tenant not paying rent: what do I do?"	HIGH	MEDIUM (Hosted in the portal, always acces
Worked case studies	Real (anonymised) Dwelly cases written up as learning examples. What happened, what the right response was, and why	VERY HIGH	MEDIUM
Compliance summaries (1-pager)	Single page per piece of legislation — deposit rules, gas safety, right to rent. Downloadable, always up to date.	MEDIUM	LOW
Role-play prompts	A scenario is given — staff write or record their response. Manager reviews and provides feedback. Mirrors T&C supervis	VERY HIGH	MEDIUM
Knowledge updates (monthly)	A short monthly "what has changed" module covering any legislation, system, or process updates that must be completed bef	HIGH	LOW (Claude drafts, Matt reviews)
"Ask Dobby first" challenges	Staff are encouraged to try Dobby before asking a manager. Dobby responses are reviewed periodically to check quality a	MEDIUM	LOW (Dobby already live)

ADDITIONAL MODULE IDEAS NOT IN THE CURRENT PLAN

Difficult Conversations	How to handle rent arrears conversations, complaint calls, and confrontational tenants. Use role-play scenario format.
Property Inspection Quality	What to look for, how to evidence it, and what triggers action. Include photo standards and report writing.
Managing Contractor Relationships	Quoting, instructing, chasing, and reviewing contractor work — including how to handle disputes.
Tenancy Renewals & Rent Reviews	The full process from initial landlord conversation to agreement. Includes market positioning and legislation.
Understanding a P&L;	Basic financial literacy for PMs — understanding service charges, deductions, and explaining costs to landlords.
Handling Disrepair Claims	Legal obligations, timescales, evidence requirements, and when to escalate to a specialist.
End of Tenancy Disputes	Step-by-step TDS dispute process, evidence standards, and how to write a compelling dispute submission.
Personal Effectiveness	Time management, inbox management, task prioritisation for PMs managing large portfolios. Not property-specific — but critical.

12-month implementation roadmap

MONTH	PHASE	FOCUS	KEY ADDITIONS VS ORIGINAL PLAN
M1–2	Foundation	Portal build + Dobby	Add competency passport framework & role pathway mapping
M3	Foundation	Content creation sprint	Build scenario-based assessments alongside standard quizzes
M4	Onboarding	First cohort intake	Activate spaced repetition engine. Day-1, Day-3, Week-1 prompts go live
M5	Onboarding	Full team through portal	Confidence ratings collected. First competency sign-off gates tested
M6	Onboarding	Baseline scores captured	Peer learning board launched. First worked case studies published
M7	Embedding	Video module library live	Video transcripts made searchable. Pre-task primers configured
M8	Embedding	Progress tracking active	Dobby Challenge Mode weekly cadence begins. Manager dashboards reviewed
M9	Embedding	Supervised period completions	First 90-day T&C sign-offs completed. CPD logs reviewed with managers
M10	Optimise	Gap analysis + refresh	First monthly re-certification round (compliance topics only)
M11	Optimise	Content update cycle	Annual content audit. Outdated modules flagged and updated via Claude
M12	Optimise	Year-end review	Competency passport export for each PM. Year 2 roadmap drafted

MEASURING WHAT MATTERS

KPI	TARGET	HOW MEASURED
Module completion rate	**100% per cohort**	Portal dashboard — manager view
Retention rate (spaced rep quizzes)	**80%+ correct at day-30 check**	Automated quiz results log
Competency sign-off rate	**100% within 90-day window**	Manager confirmation in portal
Dobby accuracy rate	**90%+ correct answers on audit**	Quarterly 20-question audit
CPD hours logged	**20 hours per PM per year**	CPD log in competency passport
Re-certification completion	**100% by end of December**	Portal completion records
Manager intervention rate	**Reduction of 30%+ by M12**	Repeat query tracking in Dobby log

Where to start

1

Define role pathways

Map the three or four distinct job roles that will use the portal. Agree with Walt and Natasha which modules each role requires. This shapes everything downstream.

2

Build the competency passport template

Design the passport before building content — it defines what "complete" looks like for each role. Use Claude to draft the framework, then sense-check against ARLA Propertymark standards.

3

Configure the spaced repetition schedule

Decide on your intervals — we recommend Day 1, Day 3, Day 7, Day 30. Build the trigger mechanism in your portal tool so completions automatically schedule follow-up prompts.

4

Write your first scenario assessment

Pick a high-stakes area — deposit deductions or maintenance emergencies. Use Claude to generate a 3-scenario assessment. Test it with your most experienced PM first to validate the answer standards.

5

Set up the Dobby Challenge cadence

Configure Dobby to send one challenge question per PM per week, drawn from recently completed modules. Start with a manual process if the automation is not yet in place — the habit matters more than the technology.

6

Launch peer learning board

Create a shared space (Notion page or Slack channel initially) where PMs can post anonymised learning moments. Seed it with two or three examples yourself to set the tone and standard.

Training is not an event. It is a system. The Dwelly programme is designed to create lasting competency — not just completed modules. Every element above is built to make knowledge stick, make gaps visible, and make great performance the default.